

**Spotify HiFi tier delayed**

Spotify's promised HiFi tier has been delayed indefinitely by the company.
<https://digit.in/feb22-08>

**Apple tipped HomePod**

Apple tipped to prepare the the new HomePod mini for its global debut.
<https://digit.in/feb22-09>



WINTER OLYMPICS HOSTED IN CHINA!

Surely it can't be controversial, right?

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**WINTER OLYMPICS SHENANIGANS****NOT!**

The 2022 Winter Olympics is taking place in Beijing, China.

Many athletes from all over the world participate in this lesser-known but prestigious edition. The event is set to start on 4th Feb, but there are certain troubles already. All troubles find their way back to the host country's administration. Ahead of the event, the United States Olympic and Paralympic Committee is advising participants to forgo their personal phones in favour of burners, afraid of digital surveillance. The Committee's concerns are not without merit. China was captured illegally planting spyware on the phones of tourists entering from the Xinjiang province in 2019. Furthermore, Citizen Lab discovered that China's My2022 Olympic app is riddled with security flaws that might lead to data leaks, surveillance, and hacking. Doesn't help China's case that the app is compulsory to install for all guests. Moreover, China

is already on "damage control" before the Olympics even start. It has enlisted the help of western TikTokers to polish its image ahead of the 2022 Winter Olympics. Such controversy before the event has even started is a Not from us.

**MAJOR GOVERNMENT HACKINGS****NOT!**

Countries across three different continents have reported their high-security government services have been hacked. Starting from mid-January, a group of hackers launched an attack on Canada's foreign ministry, which impacted most internet-based services. One of the main suspects for this attack is China, who is also accused of the hijacking of Australian Prime Minister Scott Morrison's WeChat account. Since Canada has taken a strong stance against Russian occupation of the Ukrainian border, the Russian government is also a potential suspect for this hacking. This is quite ironic considering Russia is going through major hacking scares of its own. An organisation named Belarusian Cyber-Partisans claim to have broken into and encrypted servers belonging to Belarusian Railway, the country's national state-owned railway corporation. While occasional hackings

are anticipated and worked upon by the security team of that particular government, it is scary to think about how easily and frequently these hackings are performed. It is a definitive Not.

**CONSPIRACY THEORISTS FUELED****NOT!**

When will this stop? 5G is not a new technology, and networks in other nations have been operational for several years without this difficulty. The only issue with the 5G US rollout is regarding the frequencies being used, and of course, the people standing against the whole operation. Conspiracy theorists are using the aviation industry's fears regarding the launch of 5G services near airports as "evidence" that their outlandish assertions about the technology are also real. Whether it's claims that 5G is being used to spread COVID, that the next-generation wireless technology is part of a plot to control the human population, or that turning on 5G will cause people to spontaneously explode, conspiracy theory communities are using real concerns about the technology to persuade their followers that their warnings about 5G are also true. Nobody wants their Twitter feed to be filled with more theories and opinions by these people riding on false evidence, so we give this a Not.

**DATA ROBBERY AGAIN****NOT!**

Data privacy and security is always a questionable practice in most companies, because data means big bucks. While it is considered the norm for certain data to be wrangled and sold in a borderline ethical manner (overstatement), a specific company has sought to collect very personal data, mostly financial details, for their personal gain. And the weirdest part is, they might owe you money while you haven't even heard of them! Plaid, a company which provides services to connect consumer bank accounts to apps that require payout (apps for crypto trading and online shopping, for example), is stuck in a multi-million dollar settlement for